

Solar / Lunar Observing Events

By Terri Finch, Event Manager

These are a new type of PAS-hosted events. On three days each month, it is possible to see both the Moon and the Sun in the daytime sky at a safe viewing distance from each other. PAS has set up public events at Bookmans at 19th Ave and Northern in Phoenix with telescopes to view both. Here are the dates of the next several Solar / Lunar Observing Events: Oct 15, 2017 from 11am to 1pm, Feb 11,

2018 from 10am to noon and Nov 3, 2018 from 11am to 1pm. See the PAS calendar for more details.

At the event, PAS will provide safely filtered telescopes for you to enjoy a view of the Sun which often includes sunspots, solar flares and solar prominences. Other telescopes will be set up under the blue canopy in the parking lot to view the Moon, while the PAS table with club info, hand-

outs, Q&A with prizes for the kids and Meteorite Man will be nearby. Mention you read this article and get a free PAS Bookmark from Terri. Mike with his meteorites will share stories and facts about where they landed and let you handle "rocks from space." We hope to see you at these events. Events are weather permitting so always check the website calendar www.pasaz.org to make sure the event is on.

Black Mountain Campus (BMC) Star Parties

By Terri, Events Manager

Newly added to the BMC star parties are indoor STEAM activities in the hour prior to the start of the star party. This link <https://www.carefreecavecreek.org/wp-content/uploads/2017/08/PVCC-Star-Party-STEAM-night-1.jpg> takes you to the list of Fall 2017 and Spring 2018 star parties each preceded from 6pm to 7pm with indoor activities for all ages. Star parties begin at the times shown. The STEAM programs are free to all and involve thought-provoking activities, often includ-

ing a "take home" item made by you or your child. PAS will be set up there to begin with Q&A for the attending youngsters ages 0-16. Answer an astronomy-related question, win a prize.

At dark, telescopes will be available for viewing- please enjoy a view through all the scopes and go back later for another view! As the telescopes will be changing objects throughout the night.

The dates of the next few Star Party and STEAM Nights are: (2017) Oct 19 at

7pm, Nov 9 at 7pm, (2018) Feb 15 at 7pm, Mar 8 at 7:30pm, Apr 12 at 7:30pm and May 3 at 8pm. We hope you can join us at all these events. As always, the outdoor portions of these events are weather permitting. If the weather cancels the star party portion of this event, check the PAS website calendar to see if the indoor portion of the event will still happen. Here is a flier with more details about the event: <https://www.carefreecavecreek.org/event/45113-2017-12-14/> See you there!

Rancho Gabriela Career Day May 2

By Terri, Event Manager

We had great plans for this warm day in Surprise, but PAS attendance dropped from two scopes, two helpers and Meteorite Man to only one scope and one helper.

After an early morning arrival and some wait time, we did our simple setup. William had a table with our PST on it viewing the Sun and I had a table set up with Matt helping to make sure the kids took the handouts while I did Q&A and showed the solar demo I had brought. The prizes this year for Q&A were solar viewing glasses. By the time the event ended, I had given out over 50 pairs.

After doughnuts and coffee, the event started at 9:00 am as a flood of school kids started their flow through the various indoor tables. Inside, our contact Kisha had invited various companies located in the Valley, such as Waste Management, Southwest Gas, the Fire Department, the Surprise Police Department, ASU Tempe Earth & Space department, Surprise Water department, and several other entities supporting "Career Day."

Each group of children had 20 minutes to walk around the school auditorium in-

side, then visit the telescope outside and go to the big rigs (fire, police and an APS truck) before returning to their classroom with their hands full of handout materials.

During the Q&A about how the Sun does things like create our food, one little boy insisted that the cheese falls from the sky.

After lunch, we hosted the 5th, 6th, 7th and 8th grades, finishing up around 2:00 pm.

It was an exhausting day with so many students and so much activity, but it was fun and we will most likely do it again next year. Hopefully then we will have Mike attend and Don with his solar scope, both missed at this event. Many thanks to Kisha for having PAS at this event and to Night Sky Network for providing me with a wonderful demo to share with the kids. The visual of the prominences and flares, sunspots and other features of the Sun was very well created and user friendly.

As the kids start coming through the door, the day becomes that much more interesting. They read the cards, they try to answer the questions, they get a prize for correct answers, then I ask them to go look through the scope. Photo by Terri.



Matt Kohl sitting at the PAS Table assisting Terri with Q&A. We were doing the Solar Cards & Sun Demo at this event.

Photo by Terri



William sitting near the PAS Table, taking a break from the Sun, while he waits for the next flood of kids to come look through the scope.

Photo by Terri.

